

Vi Editor Cheat Sheet

Movement Commands

Character

h, j, k, l

Left, down, up, right

Text

w, W, b, B

Forward, backward by word

e, E

End of word

(,)

Beginning of next, previous sentence

{, }

Beginning of next, previous paragraph

[,]

Beginning of next, previous section

Lines

O, \$

First, last position of current line

^

First non-blank character of current line

+, -

First character of next, previous line

H

Top line of screen

M

Middle line of screen

L

Last line of screen

nH, nL

Line *n* from top, bottom of screen

Scrolling

[Ctrl]F, [Ctrl]B

Scroll forward, backward one screen

[Ctrl]D, [Ctrl]U

Scroll down, up one-half screen

[Ctrl]E, [Ctrl]Y

Show one more line at bottom, top of window

z[Enter]

Scroll until line with cursor is at top of screen

z.

Scroll until line with cursor is at middle of screen

z-

Scroll until line with cursor is at bottom of screen

Searches

/pattern

Search forward for *pattern*

?pattern

Search backward for *pattern*

n, N

Repeat last search in same, opposite direction

/, ?

Repeat previous search forward, backward

f_x

search forward for character *x* in current line

F_x

search backward for character *x* in current line

t_x

search forward for character before *x* in current line

T_x

search backward for character after *x* in current line

;

Repeat previous current-line search

,

Repeat previous current-line search in opposite direction

Line Number

[Ctrl]G

Display current line number

nG

Move to line number *n*

G

Move to last line in file

:n

move to line number *n*

Marking Position

m_x

Mark current position as *x*

`_x

Move cursor to *x*

``

Return to previous mark or context

'_x

Move to beginning of line containing mark *x*

''

Return to beginning of line containing previous mark

Editing Commands

Insert

i, a

Insert text before, after cursor

I, A

Insert text at beginning, end of line

o, O

Open new line for text below, above cursor

Change

r

Replace with next typed characer

~	Change between uppercase and lowercase
cm	Change text block defined by movement command <i>m</i> (e.g., cw changes next word)
cc	Change current line
C	Change to end of line
R	Type over characters
s	Delete character and continue typing
S	Delete current line and continue typing

Delete, Move

x	Delete character
X	Delete character to the left of the cursor
dm	Delete text block defined by movement command <i>m</i> (e.g., dw deletes next word)
dd	Delete current line
D	Delete to end of line
p, P	Put deleted text before, after cursor
"np	Put text from delete buffer number <i>n</i> after cursor (for last nine deletions)

Yank (copy)

ym	Yank (copy) text block defined by movement command <i>m</i> (e.g., yw yanks next word)
yy, Y	Yank current line
"a yy	Yank current line into named buffer <i>a</i>
p, P	Put yanked text before, after cursor
"a P	Put text from buffer <i>a</i> before cursor

Other Commands

.	Repeat last edit command
u	Undo last edit
U	Undo changes to current line
J	Join two lines
[Ctrl]L, [Ctrl]R	Redraw screen

Invoking vi

vi file	Invoke vi editor on <i>file</i>
vi file1 file2	Invoke vi editor on files sequentially
view file	Invoke vi editor on <i>file</i> in read-only mode
vi -R file	Invoke vi editor on <i>file</i> in read-only mode
vi -r file	Recover <i>file</i> and recent edits after system crash
vi + file	Open <i>file</i> at last line
vi +n file	Open <i>file</i> at line number <i>n</i>
vi +/pattern file	Open <i>file</i> at <i>pattern</i>

Exit and Save Commands

ZZ	Save file and quit
:x	Save file and quit
:wq	Save ("write") file and quit
:w	Save file
:w!	Save file (overriding protection)
:30,60w newfile	Save lines 30 through 60 as file <i>newfile</i>
:30,60w>> file	Append lines 30 through 60 to file <i>file</i>
:w %.new	Save current buffer named <i>file</i> as <i>file.new</i>
:q	Quit
:q!	Quit, discarding any changes
Q	Quit vi and invoke ex
:e file2	Edit <i>file2</i> without leaving vi
:e! file2	Discard changes to current file, then edit <i>file2</i> without leaving vi
:n	Edit next file
:e!	Discard all changes since last save
:e#	Edit alternate file
